



**Entrepreneurial
Training &
Consulting**

**In partnership
with:**



NSF Overview

MAY 5, 2026

PRESENTER

Jerry Hollister

Executive Consultant & Co-Owner

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About BBCetc

BBCetc works with technology-based entrepreneurs and companies on strategies to advance R&D efforts to commercialization. We are nationally recognized for our success in helping clients win federal funding through the SBIR/STTR programs and use it tactically to propel growth. Services include training courses and one-on-one counseling in:

- ❑ **Commercialization Planning**
- ❑ **SBIR/STTR and Other Research Grant Assistance**
- ❑ **SBIR/STTR and Commercialization Training**
- ❑ **Grants/Contracts Management**
- ❑ **Tech-Based Economic Development Programs**



www.bbcetc.com / 734-930-9741



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JERRY HOLLISTER

- Former DOD Contracting Officer
 - US Navy Civil Engineer Corps
 - Warranted Contracting officer for DOD
- Joined BBCetc in 2017
 - Became co-Owner in Oct 2023
 - Lead the "All agencies but NIH" Team
 - Serve as reviewer for NSF, DOE, USDA and NOAA
- Led Niowave SBIR Program for >10 years
 - Over 45 SBIR/STTR awards, over \$20 million
 - Primary agencies: DOE, DOD, DHS, NSF
 - 2010 DOE SBIR/STTR Small Business of Year
 - 2016 Tibbetts Award recipient
 - Led effort that netted another >\$50M in Phase III awards
 - Niowave has signed several multi-year isotope supply agreements that each could exceed \$100 million
 - Remain on the Board of Directors



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What is the SBIR/STTR Program?

A \$5 Billion+ Federal Funding Program that supports **small businesses** to:

- Stimulate **technological innovation** to
- Develop **products** with **commercial merit**
- Create jobs

SBIR

Small Business Innovation Research

STTR

Small Business Technology Transfer

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WHAT IS SBIR/STTR?

☐ Mandated by legislation

- ☐ Newly Reauthorized Small Business Innovation and Economic Security Act (PL 119-83)
- ☐ Separate set-aside (3.2% for SBIR, 0.45% for STTR)

☐ Applies to agencies with extramural research budgets that exceed certain thresholds

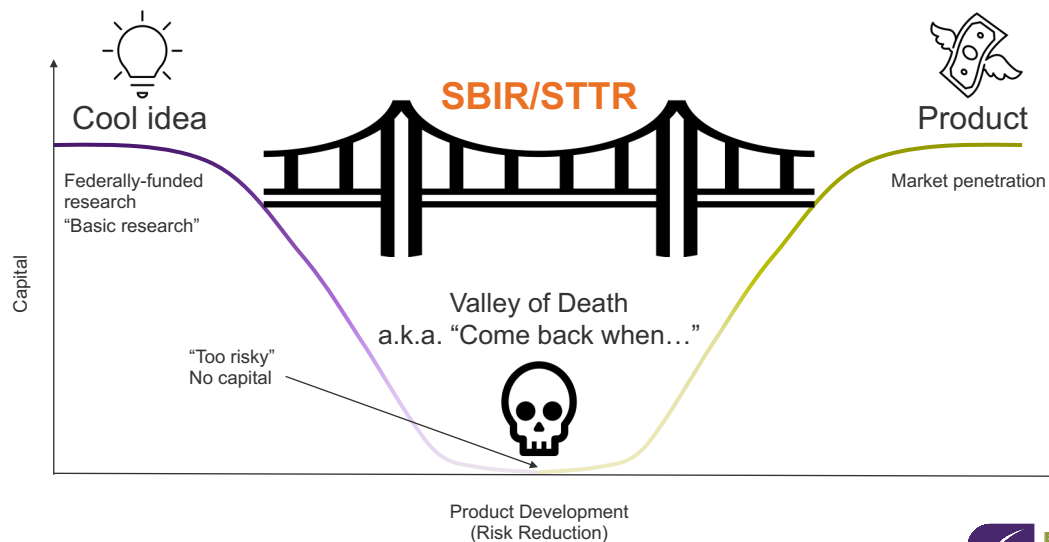
- ☐ SBIR applicable to 11 Agencies
- ☐ STTR applicable to 6 of the 11 SBIR agencies
- ☐ Participation is mandatory

☐ SBA “oversees” program implementation and compliance

- ☐ SBIR/STTR Policy Directive
- ☐ Small Business Size Regulations

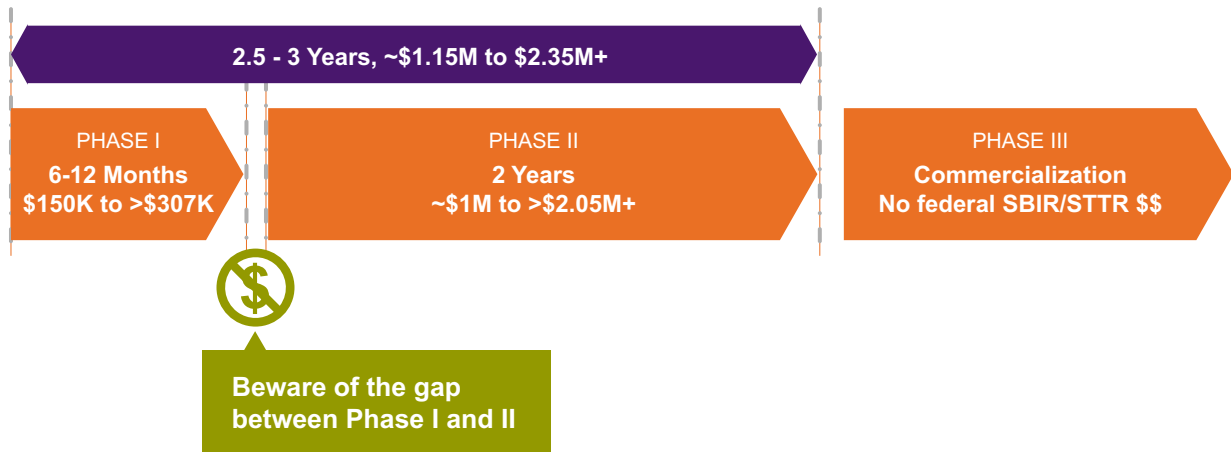
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GOAL OF SBIR/STTR PROGRAMS



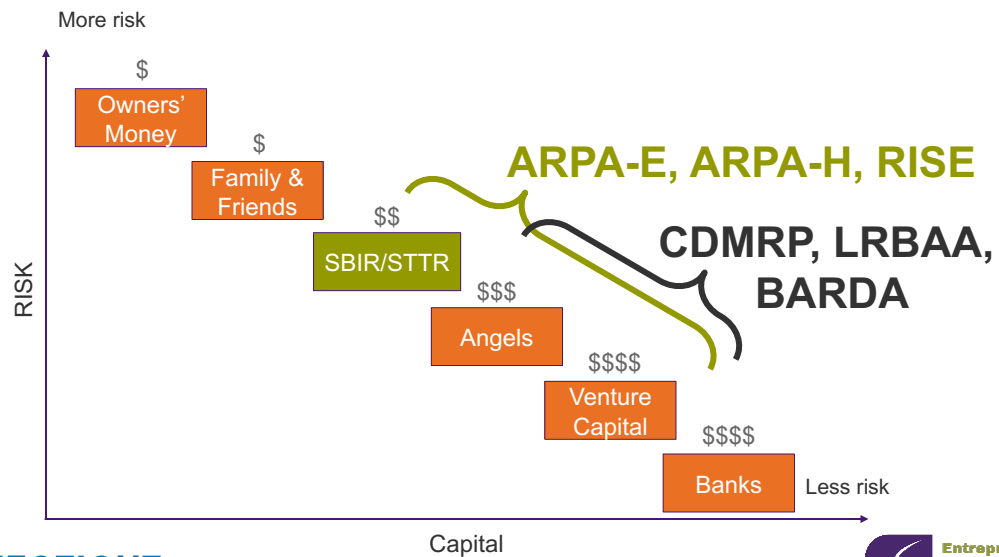
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THE BASICS OF SBIR: 3 PHASES



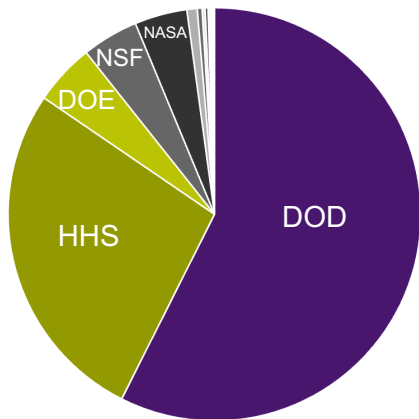
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CONTINUUM OF CAPITAL



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11 PARTICIPATING FEDERAL AGENCIES



SBIR: \$3.827 Billion
STTR: \$529 Million

SBIR and STTR	SBIR Only
DOD \$3B	DHS \$19.7 M
HHS \$1.4B	DoT \$12.4 M
DOE \$250 M	ED \$11.6 M
NSF \$231 M	DOC – NOAA \$16 M
NASA \$215 M	DOC – NIST \$5.5 M
USDA \$42 M	EPA \$5 M

TOTAL: ~\$5B

- Grant
- Contract

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YOU MUST HAVE A SMALL BUSINESS



- For-profit
- US-owned and controlled
 - > 50% owned by U.S. citizens or permanent residents
- < 500 employees
- Located in the U.S.
- R&D for grant project must be performed in the U.S.
- Company-controlled research space for grant project
- Active Registrations

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SBIR VS STTR

SBIR	STTR
Applicant is ALWAYS the Small Business Concern (SBC)	
Allows outsourcing*	Requires outsourcing* 1° subcontractor must be a non-profit research institution
Maximum outsourcing limits ≤ 33% of Phase I ≤ 50% of Phase II	Minimum participation requirements ≥ 40% by SBC ≥ 30% by SBC 1° subcontractor
PI must be employed by SBC > 50% of full time equivalent	PI may be employed by SBC or Lead Research Institute > 50% of full time equivalent ≥ 10 % effort on project
Company MUST have “company-controlled R&D facilities suitable to do work proposed”	

*outsourcing includes work done by subcontractors and consultants

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CONTRACTS VERSUS GRANTS

Contracting Agencies	Granting Agencies
☐ Agency establishes requirements ☐ Highly focused topics ☐ Procurement mechanism ☐ More fiscal requirements ☐ Invoiced on Progress, Deliverables ☐ DoD, DHS, NASA, EPA, DOT ☐ Phase III opportunity	☐ Investigator initiates approach ☐ Broad topics ☐ Assistance mechanism ☐ Budget more flexible ☐ Progress/final reports ☐ NSF, DoE, USDA
☐ Contracting <u>and</u> Granting Agencies: HHS/NIH, DOC, ED	

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IF YOU ARE WORKING WITH A UNIVERSITY



Don't forget:

Tech Transfer Office

- Intellectual Property Policy
 - Invention disclosure
- Consulting opportunities
- Conflict-of-interest policy
- Communicate early and often with Tech Transfer

Sponsored Research Office

- For all the application paperwork

Every institution has different rules (and office names!)



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NEWS BULLETIN

Small Business Innovation and Economic Security Act

- **Senate Bill S.3971 became PL 119-83 on April 13, 2026**
- **Key elements and changes:**
 - **AUTHORIZES** both SBIR & STTR (and existing pilots) until Sept 30, 2031
 - **EXPANDS** Direct to Phase II to STTR and adds DOE and NASA (keeps NIH, DOD & Education)
 - **NEW Strategic Breakthrough Awards**
 - Up to \$30 M as Phase II follow on
 - Requires 1:1 outside matching funds
 - DOD has additional matching requirements
 - **UPDATED Foreign Influence disclosures**
 - List of Prohibited Entities
 - Agencies **MUST** provide reason for denials, AND resubmission is allowed
 - **NEW Each Agency must define annual proposal limits (by company, solicitation or Topic)**
 - **NEW Phase III improvements (Agency staff training and simplified & standard procedures)**
 - **UPDATES Technical and Business Assistance (TAB A)**
 - All Agencies must participate
 - Amounts remain the same (\$6,500 Phase I, \$50,000 Phase II)
 - NEW—allows TAB A funds to be used internally
 - **NEW I-Corps Participation**
 - Allows TAB A funds to be used to pay for I-Corps
 - **Several new reporting requirements for the participating agencies**



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Overview of the NSF SBIR/STTR Program



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MISSION OF NSF

*“...to promote the progress of science;
to advance the national health,
prosperity, and welfare; and to secure
the national defense.”*



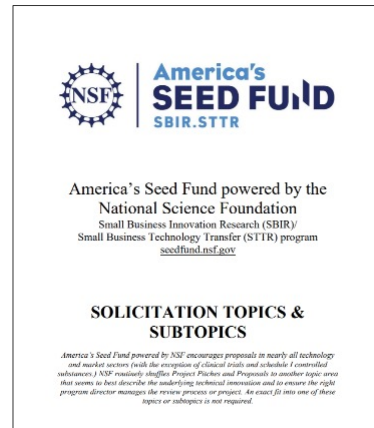
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NSF HAS 30 TOPIC AREAS + “OTHER”



Each Topic is managed by a NSF Program Director

Advanced Manufacturing (M)	Instrumentation & Hardware Systems (IH)
Advanced Materials (AM)	Internet of Things (I)
Advanced Systems for Scalable Analytics (AA)	Learning & Cognition Technologies (LC)
Agricultural Technologies (AG)	Medical Devices (MD)
Artificial Intelligence (AI)	Mobility (MO)
Augmented Virtual & Mixed Reality (AV)	Nanotechnology (N)
Biological Technologies (BT)	Pharmaceutical Technologies (PT)
Biomedical Technologies (BM)	Photonics (PH)
Chemical Technologies (CT)	Power Management (PM)
Cloud & High-Performance Computing (CH)	Quantum Information Technologies (QT)
Cybersecurity & Authentication (CA)	Robotics (R)
Digital Health (DH)	Semiconductors (S)
Emerging Technologies (EM)	Space (SP)
Energy Technologies (EN)	Wireless Technologies (W)
Environmental Technologies (ET)	Other Topics (OT)
Human-Computer Interaction (HC)	



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EXPLORING NSF TOPICS

An official website of the United States government.

Check recent critical alerts! (Last updated 4/16/2026)

NSF will resume the submission of new Project Pitches to the SBIR/STTR programs in the coming weeks. Program Directors will continue to process Project Pitches that were previously received. Please direct any questions to sbir@nsf.gov.

WE INVEST UP TO \$2 MILLION IN SEED FUNDING. AND TAKE ZERO EQUITY.

→ Start your grant process here

We fund almost all areas of technology

<https://seedfund.nsf.gov/portfolio/>



<https://seedfund.nsf.gov/portfolio/>



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EXPLORING NSF TOPICS

<https://seedfund.nsf.gov/what-we-fund/>

ADVANCED MANUFACTURING M	ADVANCED MATERIALS AM	ADVANCED SYSTEMS FOR SCALABLE ANALYTICS AA	AGRICULTURAL TECHNOLOGIES AG	ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AI	AUGMENTED VIRTUAL AND MIXED REALITY AV
BIOLOGICAL TECHNOLOGIES BT	BIOMEDICAL TECHNOLOGIES BM	CHEMICAL TECHNOLOGIES CT	CLOUD AND HIGH-PERFORMANCE COMPUTING CH	CYBERSECURITY AND AUTHENTICATION CA	DIGITAL HEALTH DH
EMERGING TECHNOLOGIES EM	ENERGY TECHNOLOGIES	ENVIRONMENTAL TECHNOLOGIES	HUMAN-COMPUTER INTERACTION	INSTRUMENTATION AND HARDWARE SYSTEMS	INTERNET OF THINGS
LEARNING AND COGNITION TECHNOLOGIES LC	MEDICAL DEVICES MD	MOBILITY MO	NANOTECHNOLOGY N	OTHER TOPICS OT	PHARMACEUTICAL TECHNOLOGIES PT
PHOTONICS PH	POWER MANAGEMENT PM	QUANTUM INFORMATION TECHNOLOGIES QT	ROBOTICS R	SEMICONDUCTORS S	SPACE SP
WIRELESS TECHNOLOGIES W					

Energy Technologies (EN)

The Energy Technologies topic addresses the research and development of novel technologies covering all aspects of energy generation, storage, and distribution.

Sub-Topics

- EN1. Advanced Nuclear Energy Tech
- EN2. CO2 and Methane Conversion, Petrochemicals, Oil and Gas
- EN3. Directed Energy
- EN4. Electromagnetics
- EN5. Energy Efficiencies and Data Technologies
- EN6. Energy Production and Power Generation
- EN7. Energy Storage
- EN8. Hydrogen Technologies
- EN9. Other Energy Technologies



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PRIOR SBIR/STTR FOA FOR REFERENCE ONLY UNTIL NEW FOA!

Solicitations

NSF Small Business Innovation Research/ Small Business Technology Transfer Program Phase I (SBIR/STTR Phase I)

24-579 PHASE I

NSF Small Business Innovation Research / Small Business Technology Transfer Programs Phase II (SBIR/STTR Phase II)

24-580 PHASE II

NSF 24-582: NSF Small Business Innovation Research / Small Business Technology Transfer Fast-Track Pilot Programs (SBIR-STTR Fast-Track)

24-582 FAST-TRACK

Proposals are submitted in “submission windows.”

- First Wednesday of March, July & November typically
- Proposal review cycle starts after window closes.



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ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS FOR NSF

PHASE I

- Eligible Small Business
- Completed required registrations
- PI that can meet employment requirements upon Notice of Award
- Approved and valid Project Pitch invitation
- Full proposal must be submitted within the **next two deadlines** after the date of invitation.

FAST-TRACK

- **Same eligibility requirements as Phase I PLUS:**
 - **NSF Lineage:** Technical innovation being developed in the Fast-Track must be derived from a prior NSF research award that is either **currently active** or **was active within the previous 5 years** from the date of submission of the Fast-Track.
 - **Customer Discovery Training:** At least one Sr/Key Personnel on the Fast-Track must have undergone formal customer discovery training in relation to the proposed technology **with the previous 2 years** from submission of the Fast-Track.
 - **Complete Team:** The entire Fast-Track team must already be in place at time of submission, (i.e., no "To be determined" team members)
- Full proposal must be submitted within **4 months** after date of Project Pitch invitation.

PHASE II

- Phase I awardees only
- Proposal must be submitted **within 6-24 months** after Phase I start date



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NSF 2024/2025 FUNDING AMOUNTS

	Goal for project Phase	Program	Max Budget	Duration
Phase I	Proof of Concept	SBIR/STTR	\$305,000	6-18 months
Phase II	Develop Minimum Viable Product	SBIR/STTR	\$1,250,000	24 months
Fast-Track	Phase I + Phase II	SBIR/STTR	\$1,555,000	24-36 months
Phase IIB	Matching funds (NSF \$1 to \$2 raised)	SBIR/STTR	\$500,000	+24 months
Phase III	Commercialization	non-SBIR	--	--



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NSF SUPPLEMENTAL FUNDING OPPORTUNITIES

Commercial Funding Opportunities

Phase IIB

- Extends R&D efforts beyond current grant to further accelerate commercialization of Phase II
- Third-party investment plus 1:2 NSF match up to \$500,000
 - For every \$2 a company brings in, NSF will match \$1, up to \$500K
- Will extend Phase II up to 24 months

Begin discussion with Program Officer EARLY!



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NSF SUPPLEMENTAL FUNDING OPPORTUNITIES

Commercial Funding Opportunities

Technology Enhancement for Commercial Partnerships (TECP)

- Funding for additional research beyond Phase II objectives
- Enhance commercial potential to lead to partnerships with industrial partners and investors
- 20% of original Phase II amount (up to \$250,000)
- Can extend Phase II up to 6 months in duration
- Up to 50 TECP per year for all of NSF

Begin discussion with Program Officer EARLY!



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NSF SUPPLEMENTAL FUNDING OPPORTUNITIES

Institutional Funding Opportunities

Community College Research Teams (Phase IICC)

- Partnership funding between small business and community college researchers and students
- \$40,000 maximum per year
- Minimum of 75% must go to Community College
- Research completed DURING Phase II (NO NCE)
- Up to 30 Phase II-CC per year for all of NSF

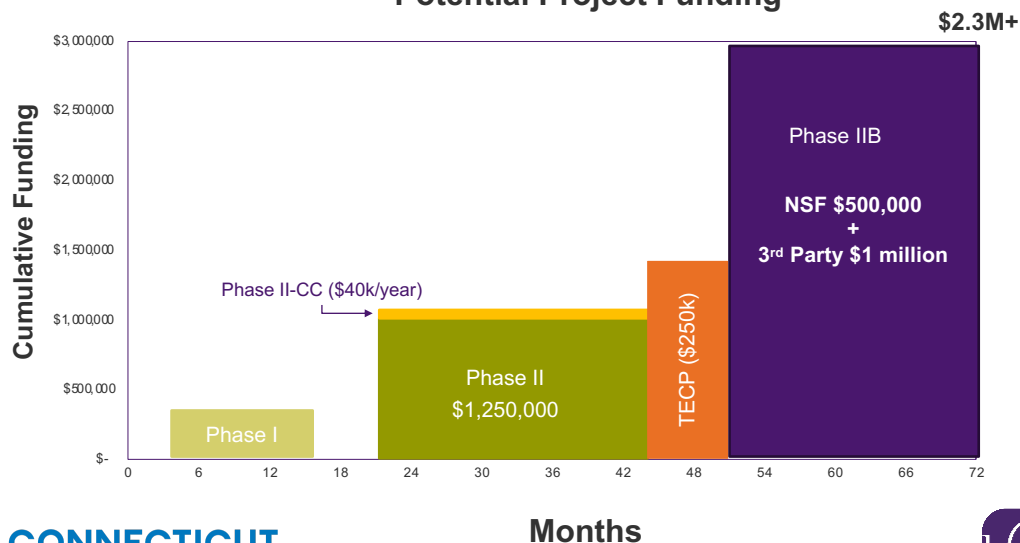
Begin discussion with Program Officer EARLY!



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NSF SUPPLEMENTAL FUNDING OPPORTUNITIES

Potential Project Funding



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MORE NSF SUPPLEMENTAL FUNDING OPPORTUNITIES

<https://seedfund.nsf.gov/resources/awardees/supplement/overview/>

Phase II awardees

Phase II reporting requirements

Forms and checklists

Revising a budget

No-cost extension

Changes at your organization

Principal investigator change

Ambassador

General award conditions

→ **Supplemental funding opportunities**

Additional opportunities

Commercial opportunities

Educational opportunities

Institutional opportunities

Supplement submission instructions

Supplemental funding overview

Only applicable for SBIR and STTR Phase II awardees.

America's Seed Fund powered by NSF is committed to assisting Phase II awardees to successfully commercialize their innovation research, grow their company, and to create jobs by attracting new investments and partnerships. To reinforce these commitments, the program supports a broad number of supplements and other opportunities.

Please notify your Program Director of your intention to submit a supplemental funding request before preparing and submitting a proposal. Supplemental funding is only available for active Phase II awardees. Please note: A no-cost extension does not extend the eligibility period for supplements. You will not be eligible to apply for or receive supplemental funding after your original award period has ended unless you have received a Technology Enhancement for Commercial Partnerships (TECP) award and the award includes an extension of your Phase II award period.

Supplemental funding: Overview video





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What makes the NSF SBIR/STTR Program Different



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KEY POINTS ABOUT NSF SBIR/STTR PROGRAM

- **NSF is a “granting” agency**
 - Investigator-initiated projects
 - Peer reviewers evaluate proposals
- **Both SBIR and STTR programs**
- **Typical success rates: Phase I: ~10-15% Phase II: ~40-50%**
- **Fund ~400 companies/year**
- **Rolling submission within “submission windows”**
- **First Step: Project Pitch**
 - Required online submission
 - Only approved Project Pitches are invited to submit a Full Proposal



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PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR RULES AT NSF

Employment

- **SBIR:** PI at least 51% **employed** at small business
- **STTR:** PI at least 51% **employed** at small business

Co-Principal Investigators

- **SBIR:** NO Co-PI allowed
- **STTR:** 1 Co-PI REQUIRED (from the lead Research Institute)

Serving on multiple proposals

- **Principal Investigator:** Only 1 NSF proposal at any time (SBIR or STTR)
- For NSF STTRs, Co-PIs from Research Institutes can serve on an unlimited number of proposals



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A GOOD FIT FOR SBIR AT NSF IF...

- ✓ You need to do **significant technical R&D** needed to overcome challenging technical hurdles in the creation of a new product or service.
- ✓ You have a **unique and defensible technical innovation** that promises to create a durable competitive advantage for your firm.
- ✓ Your company is structured and staffed for **aggressive, focused commercialization** of the new product / service.
- ✓ You have developed, and will continue to develop, **significant understanding of the market and customer**, indicating potential to meet an unmet commercial need.



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WHAT DOES NSF SBIR/STTR NOT FUND?

- **Basic Research**
 - Where primary goal is knowledge creation
- **Incremental (*Evolutionary*) improvement to existing product or service**
 - Where primary goal is to make modifications to broaden market application or scope of existing product/process
- **Analytical or “market” studies of existing technologies**
- **Projects with no strong chance of commercial success**



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SCIENCE vs ENGINEERING PROBLEMS

Science Problems	Engineering Problems
NOT widely accepted and/or NOT proven technology, process, technique(s), equation(s), reaction(s), formulation(s), etc	Widely accepted and/or proven technology, process, techniques, equations, reactions, formulations, etc
Risk: Proposed idea will not work as planned	Risk: Assembling adequate expertise and/or resources to solve the problem
NSF Phase I proposals should propose solving Science problems	NSF Phase II proposals should propose solving Engineering problems

WHO DOES NSF SBIR/STTR FUND?

Source: NSF Program Director (2025)

Company Size: 94% of awardees have less than 10 employees

History: 90% of awardees have never had a prior SBIR/STTR Phase II award from any agency

Company Age: 80% of awardee companies were created within the past 5 years

First-Timers: 62% of Phase I NSF SBIR/STTR awardees are new to NSF



NSF SBIR/STTR Review Criteria

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NSF PHASE I REVIEW CRITERIA

Merit Review Criteria

1. Intellectual Merit

- Potential to advance knowledge
- Leverages fundamental science or engineering **research** techniques to overcome **technical risk**
 - Application of creative, original, transformative concepts
 - Project is well-reasoned, well-organized, based on sound rationale
 - Novel integration of new theories, analysis, data, or methods
- **Technological Innovation:** The new product or service is differentiated from current products or services and has a durable competitive advantage.
- Well-qualified team to conduct the proposed activities
- Plan incorporates mechanisms to assess success
- Adequate resources.

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NSF PHASE I REVIEW CRITERIA

Merit Review Criteria

2. Broader Impacts
 - Potential to benefit society
 - **Positive** society and economic outcomes



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NSF PHASE I REVIEW CRITERIA

Solicitation-Specific Review Criteria

3. Commercial Impact
 - Proposed product addresses an unmet, important, and scalable need for the target customer base.
 - Small business is structured and staffed to focus on aggressive commercialization of the product.
 - Small business can provide evidence of good product-market fit.
 - Competitive advantage based on scientific or technological innovation
 - Compelling business model
 - Company team has potential for strong commercial outcomes
 - NSF support will serve as a catalyst.



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PROPOSAL SCORING

Possible Reviewer Ratings of Overall Proposal

Excellent – Outstanding in all respects; highest priority for support

Very Good – High quality in nearly all respects; support if at all possible

Good – Quality proposal; worthy of support

Fair – Lacks one or more critical aspects; issues need to be addressed

Poor – Has serious deficiencies

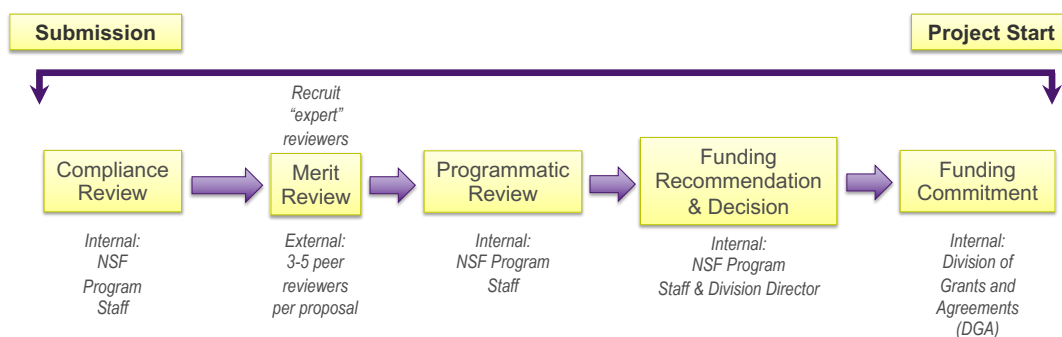
Panel will rate the proposal as one of the following:

Not Competitive, Low Competitive, **Competitive**, **Highly Competitive**



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NSF APPLICATION REVIEW PROCESS



Program Director is the key decision maker



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Planning Your Phase I SBIR/STTR



**Defining
the Product by
the Market
Opportunity**

**Differentiating
Your Innovative
Solution**



**The Technical
Objectives
& Milestones**

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WHAT DOES SBIR FUND?



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**Research & Development
toward a Product**

**Product must be based on
Technological Innovation**

**Credible
Commercialization
Strategy**

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PHASE I & II AT GRANTING AGENCIES

- ☐ Granting agencies will NOT buy your product.
- ☐ Goal in **Phase I** is to prove feasibility of the proposed product.
 - ☐ **Solve science problem**
- ☐ The focus of your **Phase II** proposal will be on showing commercial viability.
 - ☐ **Solve engineering problem(s)**
 - ☐ Evidence of extensive market validation

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MOST COMMON PITFALL

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4
Product Development	→	→		
Business Development			→	→

“Technology Push”

Develop product, THEN ask customers what they want

“Solution in search of a problem”

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4
Product Development	→	→		
Business Development	→	→		

“Market Pull”

Product Development and Customer Development go hand-in-hand.

You develop the solution the customer *will* pay for (aka “market pull”)

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NSF I-CORPS



- Provides funding and training for customer discovery
 - 7 weeks, 100+ interviews for **National** program
- Develop **entrepreneurship skills**
- **National I-Corps Project team:** Technical Lead/PI, Entrepreneurial Lead, Mentor
- Check out the **regional** programs!
 - ~3-4 weeks, 25+ interviews



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TELL A STORY WITH YOUR PROPOSAL

There's an important problem.



Why is it important?
Important to whom?

Current solutions are inadequate.



What are the alternatives?
What are their shortcomings?

Our approach is innovative.



What is the approach?
How is it different?
Why will you win?

There's a viable commercial opportunity.



What is the product?
Who is the target customer?

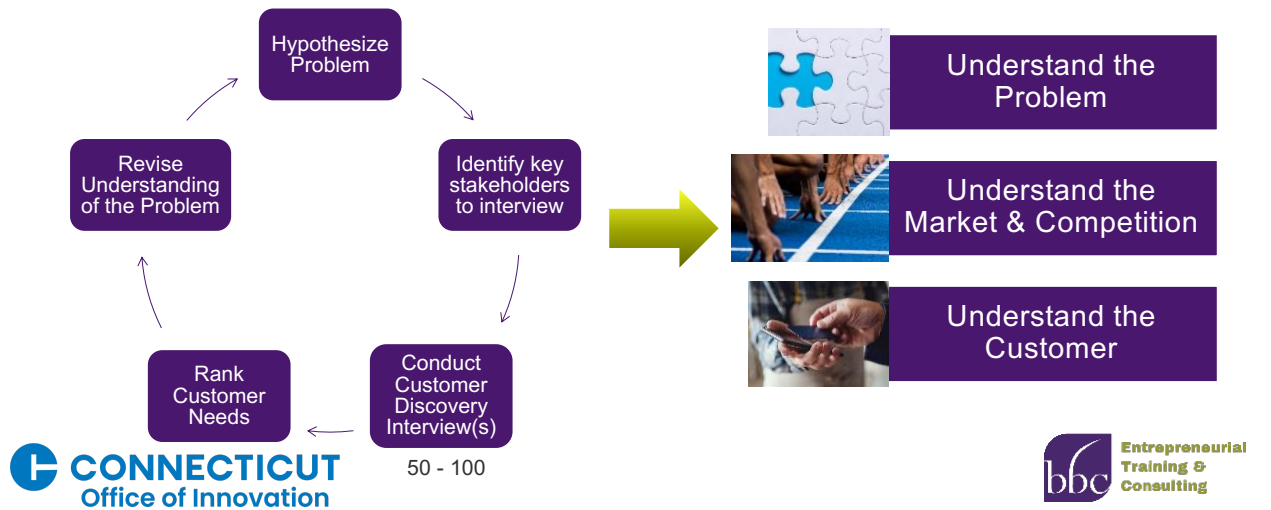


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CUSTOMER DISCOVERY

What features does your product need to have to meet customer needs?

How have you validated the significance of these features?



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WHAT IS FEASIBILITY?

It's Project-Dependent.

Innovative Technology = Risky



"Can't work" → "Technical Challenges" → "Should work"

What data are needed?

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OBJECTIVES VS. TASKS

➤ Objectives = Achievements

- Do **not** yield results/data
- Have desired, measurable end points



➤ Tasks = Activities

- Make up your work plan
- They are performed or carried out
- Yield results/data



OBJECTIVES VS. TASKS

Objectives

- “To demonstrate...”
- “To prove...”
- “To establish...”
- “To validate...”
- “To confirm...”



Tasks

- “To study...”
- “To experiment...”
- “To test...”
- “To measure...”
- “To collect...”
- “To conduct...”

TECHNICAL OBJECTIVE - EXAMPLE

Tech Obj: Demonstrate a localized gravitational field inversion array can generate sufficient upward force to achieve sustained, controlled flight of a standard domestic pig

Success Criteria:

- 1) net upward lift force $\geq 1,200$ N
- 2) sustained flight altitude ≥ 1 m maintained for ≥ 30 continuous seconds without mechanical assist, as measured by laser rangefinder at 10 Hz sampling rate
- 3) animal biometric readings remain within AVMA-defined safe physiological ranges throughout flight duration: heart rate < 200 bpm, core temperature $\Delta T < 1.5^{\circ}\text{C}$

	Critical Task	Team Member
1	Design and assemble prototype	Awardee Tech, LLC
2	Obtain approved IACUC for animal testing	IACUC lab
3	Confirm key functions of field inversion array	Awardee Tech, LLC
4	Conduct 10 flight tests monitoring relevant data points	Awardee Tech, LLC
5	Perform statistical analysis & draw conclusions	Dr. John Consult



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BUDGET - SBIR EXAMPLE

Critical Task	Team Member	Hours	Price
Design & assemble prototype	SubWorks Corp	500	\$47,000
Confirm key features	Awardee Tech, LLC	1,000	\$66,750
Produce test samples	Awardee Tech, LLC	1,200	\$63,000
Produce control samples	Midwest Univ	250	\$30,000
Measure tensile strength	Breakit Labs, Ltd.	50	\$7,500
Perform statistical analysis	Dr. John Consult	80	\$10,000
Materials & supplies	-		\$10,800
Travel & indirect costs	-		\$50,000
Fee (profit)	-		\$19,950

= \$87K

Total \$305,000

\$87k/\$305k = 28.5%



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How to Prepare the NSF Project Pitch

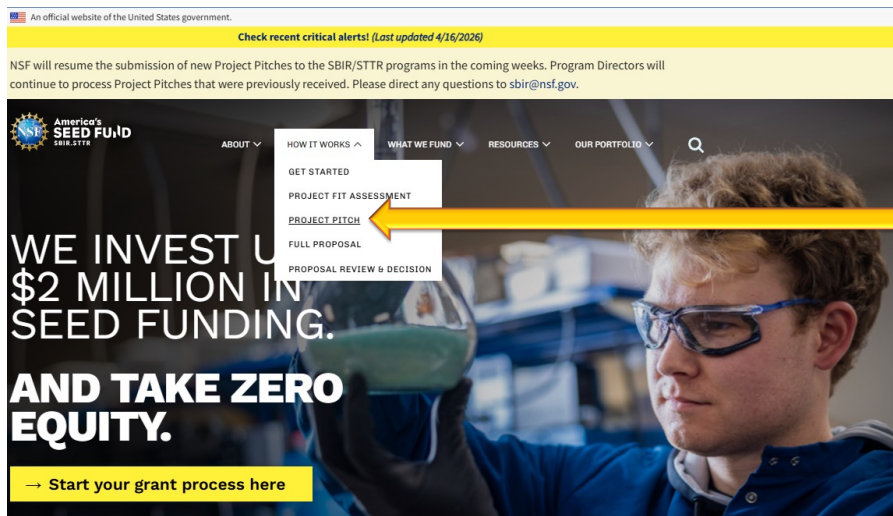
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HOW TO PREPARE THE PROJECT PITCH

An official website of the United States government.

Check recent critical alerts! (Last updated 4/16/2026)

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**WE INVEST UP TO \$2 MILLION IN SEED FUNDING.
AND TAKE ZERO EQUITY.**

[→ Start your grant process here](#)

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RULES FOR YOUR PROJECT PITCH

- Each small business can only **submit one Project Pitch at a time.**
- A company is limited to **one Project Pitch per submission window:**
 - July 1, 2026 (estimated)
 - Nov 4, 2026 (estimated)
- Any small business with a pending Project Pitch **must wait for a response** before submitting another Project Pitch.
- Any small business that has received an invitation to submit a full proposal **must wait for a resolution of the full proposal** before submitting a new or revised Project Pitch.



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WHAT TO NOTE IN YOUR PROJECT PITCH

The Technology Innovation (up to 3500 characters – includes spaces!)

- Describe the technical innovation; what is new, innovative and unproven about your proposed product.

The Technical Objectives and Challenges (up to 3500 characters)

- Describe the technical risks that need to be overcome to establish feasibility of your idea and allow your innovative product to become commercially viable.

The Market Opportunity (up to 1750 characters)

- Describe the customer profile and the problem these customers face in the marketplace

The Company & Team (up to 1750 characters)

- Describe the background and current status of the small business, and the key team members



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FAST-TRACK PROJECT PITCH

Same four sections as the regular Phase I Project Pitch PLUS:

NSF Lineage (up to 1050 characters):

- NSF award number(s) that supported the technology innovation that is the focus of the Fast-Track.
- Key personnel involved in each listed research award and their roles in those projects
- Brief explanation of how the cited research funding relates to the proposed Fast-Track project.

Customer Discovery Training (up to 1750 characters):

- Provide details of the customer discovery training completed.
- If NSF I-Corps, provide dates and award number.
- If not I-Corps, provide sufficient information (program name, dates, URL) for review.
- Confirm this program was completed for the technology being developed in the Fast-Track.

Complete Fast-Track Team:

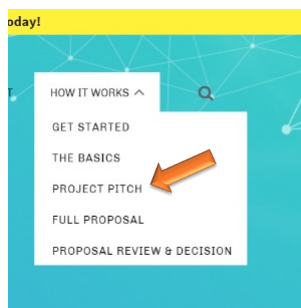
- Check “Yes” or “No” to indicate whether the Fast-Track team will be complete at the time of proposal submission.



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HOW TO SUBMIT A PROJECT PITCH

Submit Online at NSF SBIR website: <https://seedfund.nsf.gov/apply/project-pitch/>



What's next

Once you determine if your project is a fit through the assessment and you have reviewed the instructions, submit your Project Pitch online. Typically, it takes about 1-2 months to get an official response from NSF staff.

If the Project Pitch indicates the innovation is suitable for the program, NSF will extend an official invitation for the company to submit a full proposal. If an invitation is not extended, a brief explanation will be shared with the company.

Submit your project pitch to apply for an NSF grant

*Only one Project Pitch per submission deadline is allowed, and a small business with a pending Project Pitch, Open Invitation, or full SBIR or STTR Phase I proposal under review must wait to receive a response before submitting another Project Pitch.



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PROJECT PITCH OUTCOMES

Phase I

If **YES**: Submit within next two submission deadlines of invitation*

If **more information needed**, provide requested info.

If **NO**: Try again in the next quarter

Fast-Track

If **YES**: Submit within 4 months of invitation

If **YES, BUT**: If the project is a good fit, but you do not meet FT eligibility requirements, you will be considered under a traditional Phase I.

If **more information needed**, provide requested info.

If **NO**: Try again in the next quarter

*If you have an approved Phase I Pitch but really want to do Fast-Track, you must request the invitation be withdrawn and then submit a Fast-Track Pitch.



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AFTER GETTING INVITATION TO SUBMIT...

- Collect all the documents you will need.
 - Current Year solicitation
 - Bookmark the Research.gov help site
 - PAPPG (https://nsf-gov-resources.nsf.gov/files/nsf24_1.pdf)
- Confirm all your registrations are active
 - SAM.gov
 - SBIR.gov
 - Research.gov
- Start planning your project



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SBIR/STTR PHASE I PROPOSAL ELEMENTS



REQUIRED

- 1) Cover Sheet
- 2) SBIR/STTR Phase I Questionnaire
- 3) SBIR/STTR Phase I Certification Questions
- 4) Project Summary
- 5) Project Description (maximum 15 pages)
- 6) References Cited
- 7) Budget & Sub-budgets
- 8) Budget Justification(s)
- 9) Facilities, Equipment, and Other Resources
- 10) Senior Personnel Documents (PI & Senior Personnel)
 - Biographical Sketch*
 - Current and Pending (Other) Support*
 - Collaborators & Other Affiliations*
 - Synergistic Activities
- 11) Data Management & Sharing Plan
- 12) Mentoring Plan *(if postdocs are on subcontract; conditionally required)*

OPTIONAL

- 1) IP Rights Agreement (Cooperative Research Agreement)
- 2) Other Personnel Biographical Information
- 3) Other Supplementary Documents
 - Company Commercialization History
 - Letters of Commitment from Subs/Consultants
 - Resubmission Change Description
- 4) List of Suggested Reviewers
- 5) List of Reviewers NOT to include
- 6) Deviation Authorization (very rare)
- 7) Additional Single Copy Documents
 - PDF of approved Pitch email (REQUIRED)



Orange: Form to be filled out

Purple: Upload file(s)

*Must use NSF Form



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NSF PHASE I PROJECT DESCRIPTION



Minimum 10 pages, Maximum 15 pages

- 1) Intellectual Merit (7-10 pages recommended)
- 2) Company/Team (1-2 pages recommended)
- 3) Broader Impacts (1-2 pages recommended)
- 4) Commercialization Potential (1-3 pages recommended)

NO URLS or websites are allowed in the Project Description!



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COMPANY NEEDS A TEAM

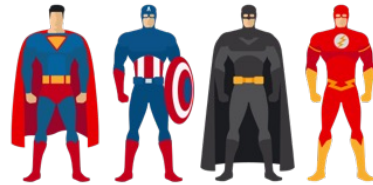
“STAFFED FOR AGGRESSIVE, FOCUSED COMMERCIALIZATION”

Roles you should have on your team

- Technical (including product development)
- Customer discovery / development
- Intellectual Property
- Fundraising
- Management & administration

Possibly:

- Regulatory / other specialist



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COMMERCIALIZATION PLAN ELEMENTS

- Describe Market & Addressable Market
- How have you validated the opportunity?
- Describe your customers and your business model
- Describe the competition
- Outside resources and partners
- Finance Plan



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SCHEDULING BASICS

Give yourself *at least 8-12 weeks* to plan the project, write the Project Description, and secure your key personnel

- ☐ Confirm eligibility and registrations
- ☐ Understand the solicitation cycle and deadline
- ☐ Conduct customer discovery
- ☐ Finalize team & resource requirements
 - ☐ Give University / National labs partners 4 weeks to complete paperwork
 - ☐ Contingent hires
 - ☐ Consultants & Subawardees
- ☐ Have someone outside your organization read the proposal



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PREPARING A SUBMISSION TO NSF

Get an Early Start

- Confirm eligibility.
- Collect the documents you'll need Register your company (SBIR.gov, SAM, Research.gov).
- Submit a **Project Pitch** to find out if NSF is right for this proposal.
- Submit **Full Proposal** by your designated window close – NO GRACE PERIOD!
 - Clearly articulate the innovation.
 - Clearly lay out the validated market pull.
 - Describe a well rounded team



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Questions?



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LET BBCetc KNOW HOW WE DID

IT'S ONLY 6 QUESTIONS AND WE REALLY CARE!

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Thank you!



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